

## DAY 10: EAT OUT FOR LESS

My number one spending downfall (besides buying more books than I could possibly read in a lifetime) is eating out at local restaurants and fast food chains. There are many days when I simply don't feel like cooking, or have time to cook, and the easiest solution is to let someone else do it for me.

Especially on Sundays.

There's nothing more satisfying than stepping outside those church doors, knowing that you don't have to fix the noon meal. The hardest part is actually deciding *where* to go!

But I'd be blind if I didn't notice that restaurants (even fast food ones) have jumped in price over the past few years. \$10-\$15 for a simple meal, \$4-\$5 for an ice cream cone—it's getting insane. It's simply not practical to sacrifice your entire food budget for the sake of convenience, not when you can eat at home for much less. Plus, if you have a big family, eating out gets even more expensive. It's not like restaurant-grade meals are always the healthiest food to eat either.

While I would hate to give up our love for restaurants indefinitely (because I think they can be enjoyed in moderation), there are some really smart ways to make eating at home more enjoyable, and eating out practically a steal. Try these six ideas the next time you want to head out on the town without the guilt!

### 1. MAKE MEALS YOU ACTUALLY LIKE

Many times, my reason for eating out is simply that I don't like any of the meals we've been making at home. Either that, or they've become too boring.